

Standard Chartered Plc (HK) (2888)

Expected negative share price reaction to CFO exit;
positive fundamental outlook unchanged

Standard Chartered Group has announced the immediate departure of CFO Diego De Giorgi, who will be joining Apollo Global Management as Partner and Head of EMEA, according to Apollo's announcement ([link](#)). Given Diego's positive reputation among investors and his role in recent financial milestones for STAN, including a significant share buyback and improved ROTE, *we anticipate a low- to mid-single-digit decline in STAN's share price as a result of his unexpected exit*. Despite this, our investment outlook remains positive, as the bank's robust performance is underpinned by ongoing strategic transformation and favorable monetary conditions. We view any potential over-correction in the share price as a compelling opportunity to accumulate.

- **What's new?** Standard Chartered Group announced that its CFO, Diego De Giorgi, has stepped down with immediate effect ([link](#)), and Apollo Global Management announced that Diego will join the firm as Partner and Head of EMEA ([link](#)). STAN has appointed Deputy CFO and Group Head of Central Finance, Peter Burrill, as Interim Group CFO while a permanent successor is sought. De Giorgi joined the bank in September 2023 and was appointed Group CFO in January 2024. Burrill has been with Standard Chartered since 2017, previously held senior finance roles at Deutsche Bank, and began his career at KPMG (Table 1).
- **Expected negative market reaction:** We anticipate Diego's unexpected departure will trigger a low- to mid-single-digit percentage point pullback in STAN's share price. We believe Diego is well regarded by investors; notably, STAN's normalized ROTE expanded by ~700bps from 2023 to 9M25 (annualized), and the share price has risen 210% since January 2024 (vs HSI +62%). Thus, the negative share price reaction post-announcement is in line with our expectations.
- **Investment view unchanged, over-correction an opportunity:** We maintain our positive outlook on STAN ([note](#)). The bank's strong financial performance over the past two years has been primarily driven by the monetary cycle and a decade-long transformation under CEO Bill Winters, who joined in May 2015. We do not expect Diego's departure to derail STAN's ROTE expansion trajectory. Furthermore, as Bloomberg [notes](#), Diego is leaving for a senior role at Apollo, not a direct competitor, which should ease investor concerns. Should the share price correction reach high single digits or even double digits, we see this as an attractive opportunity to accumulate STAN.
- **What to expect next?** STAN is expected to update its ROTE and total shareholder return (TSR) guidance on 24 February 2026 during its 4Q25 results briefing. We do not anticipate the departure to cause major

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Overweight

2888.HK, 2888 HK

Price: HK\$202.00

09 Feb 2026

Price Target: HK\$265.00

PT End Date: 31 Dec 2026

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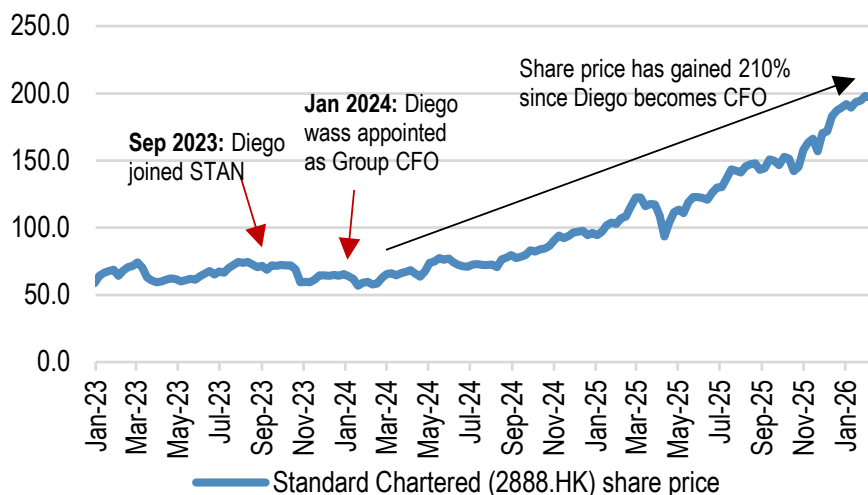
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surprises to the ROTE or TSR trajectory. Additionally, STAN will provide further medium- to long-term guidance at its corporate day in May. Investors should also monitor the search for a new CFO; we believe the market will look for a candidate with a strong banking/finance background and proven ability to communicate effectively with investors.

Figure 1: STAN's share price gained 210% since Diego was appointed as Group CFO in Jan 2024



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Note: As of 9 Feb 2026 closing.

Table 1: Background of interim CFO Peter Burrill

Time	Role
Sep 1993 – Jun 2013	Multiple roles until Partner, KPMG
Jul 2013 – May 2017	Group Controller, Co-Head of Group Finance, Deutsche Bank
Jun 2017 – Jan 2021	CFO, Group Finance, Standard Chartered Bank
Jan 2021 – Present	Group Head of Central Finance and Deputy CFO, Standard Chartered Bank
Apr 2025 – Present	Chairman of the Supervisory Board, Standard Chartered Bank

Source: Company website.

Investment Thesis

We see StanChart as undervalued relative to its sector/EM peers at 1.1x PTNAV with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. We expect a ~7% revenue CAGR over '23-26E, driven by non-NII led by Wealth and Financial Markets, with the group's previous investments producing revenue momentum. NII is likely to be under pressure in '25-26E owing to lower rates, although this would be partly offset by volume growth, increased structural hedging and assertively managed deposits pass-through. We estimate a ~4% cost CAGR with the group's restructuring program likely to drive material cost saves by FY26, supporting a PPOP CAGR of 12% and RoTE reaching 13.8%/13.5% in FY25E/26E. Capital remains strong; we forecast distributions of ~\$10.9bn compared to group targets of >\$8bn in '24-26E and expect a further \$1.5bn of share buybacks to be announced with FY25 results. CRE remains a risk, although we see the group as better positioned compared to peers and pro-actively managing higher-risk exposures lower. Maintain OW.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of HK\$265 is derived from our DDM analysis with NAV discounted back to Dec-26 from FY28E and a fair P/B of 1.5x. Our key assumptions are a normalized ROE of 11.8% and a cost of capital of 9.3%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

The key downside risks to our rating and price target include:

- **Macroeconomic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macroeconomic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross-border and political risks. Potential weakness in China macro and regional sovereign continue to be risks towards revenues and impairments in the near term, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions to grow to above normalized levels by 2025 given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.
- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to the changes in the regulatory environment in the UK with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

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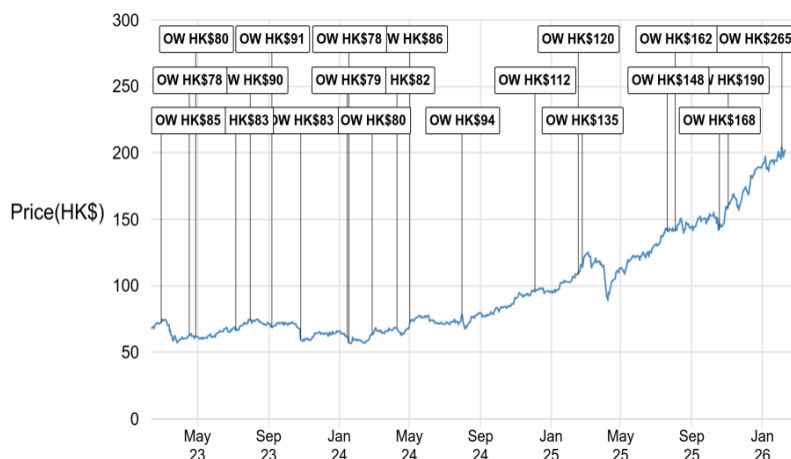
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Standard Chartered Plc (HK) (2888) (2888.HK, 2888 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 24, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
28-Feb-23	OW	72.50	85
18-Apr-23	OW	63.05	78
28-Apr-23	OW	61.95	80
07-Jul-23	OW	66.55	83
01-Aug-23	OW	74.25	90
07-Sep-23	OW	69.20	91
27-Oct-23	OW	59.75	83
16-Jan-24	OW	61.55	79
18-Jan-24	OW	57.35	78
28-Feb-24	OW	63.35	80
10-Apr-24	OW	68.25	82
03-May-24	OW	71.95	86
31-Jul-24	OW	76.90	94
04-Dec-24	OW	96.80	112
17-Feb-25	OW	108.20	120
24-Feb-25	OW	116.00	135
22-Jul-25	OW	141.30	148
04-Aug-25	OW	141.30	162
19-Oct-25	OW	142.00	168
03-Nov-25	OW	157.80	190
05-Feb-26	OW	203.40	265

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